

Website Summary & Description — Get Goods Gratis (Free)

A plain-language overview of the website and apps, prepared for counsel. Its purpose is to orient a lawyer to **what the platform is, who uses it, what it does, and how it makes money** before turning to the issue-specific documents in this packet. **Not legal advice** — it is a description of the product so that a legal review is faster and better grounded. Current as of 2026-09-11.

1. In one paragraph

Get Goods Gratis (Free) is an 18-and-over **retail / e-commerce marketplace** — a website plus companion mobile apps — where people shop for goods and, alongside the storefront, can browse a searchable games category, take surveys, and engage with advertising to earn on-platform store credit that is spent on those same goods. Its tagline is **“Where Global Goods Gather”** — paired in the brand lockup with the descriptor **“Buy Anything Available Online”** — and its intended web address is **getgoodsgratis.com**. The defining feature is a **closed-loop economy**: everyday users never receive cash — what they earn stays as non-cashable **store credit (“Site Cash”)** usable only inside the platform — while **real money flows only between the platform and businesses** (advertisers who buy campaigns, and partners such as affiliates and developers who receive a revenue share). An AI layer generates and optimizes advertising and progressively automates routine operations, with **permanent human/compliance gates** on anything touching money, identity, or legal matters.

2. What the site is (and is not)

- **It is** a consumer retail marketplace that bundles shopping with optional earn-and-reward mechanics (surveys, a searchable games category, attention/ad engagement, referrals, and a skill-based prize competition), funded by business advertising rather than by marking goods up to the consumer.
- **It is not** a bank, a money-transmitter, an investment or lending service, a cash-out “get paid” app, or a gambling site. Consumer balances are **closed-loop store credit**, not money; the prize competition is **skill/merit-based with a free entry option**, not a random-draw lottery.
- **Positioning note for counsel:** the brand repositioned from a “play games, earn” framing to a **retail-first** identity. Games are now **one searchable store category** among others, not a pillar and not a curated catalog: users search for any game available online and buy or download it through the store, on the **same zero-inventory sourcing/fulfillment model as every other product** (the store holds no inventory). Marketing copy across the site now leads with shopping; surveys/rewards and the games category are presented as secondary features. This matters for how the product is characterized (retail commerce vs. a rewards/gaming app). See `GAMES-TO-RETAIL-PIVOT-DECISIONS-2026-09-09.md` for the full decision record. `PENDING COUNSEL REVIEW (games→retail pivot, 2026-09-09)`.

3. Who uses it (the audiences)

Audience	What they do	Money direction
Consumers (users)	Shop for goods; optionally earn store credit by taking surveys, engaging with ads, and referring others; redeem credit for goods. Must be 18+ .	They spend money on goods and/or earn non-cashable store credit. No cash is ever paid out to them.
Business advertisers	Buy advertising campaigns and placements (tiered products, sponsored listings, boosts) to reach the user base.	They pay real money to the platform.
Partners (affiliates / developers / endorsers)	Refer business or supply integrations/content; receive a revenue share.	They receive real money as vendor/revenue-share payouts (1099-reported).
Platform operator / admins	Operate the marketplace, approve gated features, run compliance controls.	Receives advertiser revenue; pays partner shares and fulfills goods.

4. What a user can do (core features & flows)

- **Shop the marketplace** — browse and acquire goods; store credit and/or payment methods apply at checkout.
- **Earn store credit** — complete surveys, engage with advertising/attention units, and complete daily/goal-based activities. The core ad-engagement surface is a **full-screen ad-grid experience**: the user taps **one** ad tile, which opens a full-screen takeover where the advertiser's video/audio loops through a short (30-second) watch gate; the questions then appear beneath the still-looping ad, the user submits (credited server-side), the real product page reveals, and the user **swipes straight to the next ad** — tapping the grid only once. Earnings accrue as **Site Cash** (closed-loop credit), never cash.
- **Refer others** — a **single-tier** referral program (no multi-level/downline structure); referral rewards are tied to real activity and are clawback-gated against fraud.
- **Enter the prize competition** — a **skill/merit-based** prize pool with a genuine **no-purchase-necessary (AMOE)** free-entry path; 18+ and jurisdiction-gated; official rules generated from settings.
- **Social / community features** — e.g., “Buddy Chat,” social shopping, and community surfaces (several are gated and enabled selectively).
- **Account, privacy, and legal surfaces** — in-app Privacy Policy and Terms pages (public), consent capture, and a working tracking opt-out.

Business-facing flows include campaign purchase, tiered advertiser products (Tier 1-3), sponsored listings, deposits/prepayment options, and AI-assisted creative — described in the monetization and compliance docs.

5. How the money works (the closed loop)

The economic model is the single most important thing for a legal reviewer to understand:

- **Inbound**: businesses pay the platform for advertising and placements (the platform's primary revenue).
 - **Consumer side**: users earn **store credit only** — it is non-cashable, cannot be withdrawn, and is spent exclusively on goods within the platform. This is enforced at every money rail and automation.
 - **Outbound cash**: real cash leaves the platform **only to business partners** (affiliates, developers, advertisers) as a revenue share / vendor payment, with tax reporting (1099) and backup-withholding wired in.
 - **Why it's structured this way**: keeping consumer value closed-loop is a deliberate choice to stay clear of money-transmission and cash-out characterizations; paying only businesses keeps outbound flows as ordinary vendor payments. Counsel is asked to confirm this posture (see FOR-YOUR-ATTORNEY.md §1).
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6. How it makes money (revenue streams, high level)

The platform is **advertiser-funded**. Revenue streams include tiered advertiser products (**Tier 1 entry, Tier 2 “Scale,” Tier 3 “Unlimited”**), a **founding pre-revenue offer** for early businesses, sponsored listings and premium boosts, affiliate/partner revenue share, and other B2B advertising products. **PPC network advertising is a shared feature included across all three tiers (Tier 1/2/3)**. The **founding pre-revenue offer grants the maximum (Tier 3) capability level of every feature, free** — a capability grant, not an impression-volume one. Detailed mechanics, pricing, and the auto-renew/deposit terms live in the monetization and pricing documents (`PROFIT-FLYWHEEL-AND-MONETIZATION-BLUEPRINT.md` , `REVENUE-STREAMS-EXPANSION.md` , `ADVERTISER-PRICING-2026.md` , and the Tier 2 items in `FOR-YOUR-ATTORNEY.md` §8-§9).

7. Technology & AI (what's under the hood)

- **Delivery**: a responsive **website (PWA)** plus **native/wrapped mobile apps** (Capacitor), backed by a **serverless back end** of roughly **980 functions across ~180 subsystem modules**.
- **AI advertising engine**: generates, tests, and optimizes advertising creative across owned and social surfaces (including AI-generated images/video).
- **Graduated-autonomy automation**: AI progressively takes over routine operational decisions under measured trust, but **permanent, non-overridable gates** keep human/compliance control over **money, identity, and legal** actions, plus a global kill-switch.
- **AI-content disclosure**: AI-generated creative carries a visible “AI-generated” label and machine-readable **C2PA**

content-credential provenance (see `AI-CONTENT-DISCLOSURE-DESIGN.md`).

8. Compliance posture at a glance

The platform ships in a deliberately **conservative default state**; anything money-, credit-, minor-, or chance-related is held OFF behind a named admin switch until counsel clears it. Highlights:

- **Age:** hard **18+** floor; teen/minor accounts gated OFF.
- **Consumer funds:** **closed-loop, non-cashable** store credit — not money transmission.
- **Prize competition:** **skill/merit-based + AMOE free entry**, jurisdiction-gated — structured to avoid a lottery/gambling characterization.
- **Earnings claims:** no forward earnings promises; results are hypothetical-until-substantiated; FTC-aligned advertising copy.
- **Privacy:** GDPR/CCPA-oriented consent + opt-out; session-replay analytics ship OFF.
- **Credit products:** exist only as gated scaffolding; cannot originate without a licensed provider **and** counsel sign-off.
- **AI content:** visible label + C2PA provenance to meet platform/FTC/EU AI-Act disclosure expectations.

The exact switches, defaults, and the specific questions for counsel are enumerated in `FOR-YOUR-ATTORNEY.md` (compliance checklist) and the topic briefs alongside it.

9. Current status

The platform is **built to the conservative posture described above and is approaching launch** (pre-revenue). The single developer/owner is **Ben Vick**; the source lives in the GitHub repository `benjaminjohnvick-cmyk/playearningnexus`. Key blanks to fill before launch (business mailing address, DMCA agent, governing-law/jurisdiction selections, terms version) are listed in `FOR-YOUR-ATTORNEY.md` §10.

10. Where to go next in this packet

- **Compliance sign-off checklist:** `FOR-YOUR-ATTORNEY.md` — the specific items needing a lawyer's approval.
- **Trademark:** `TRADEMARK-FILING-BRIEF.md` + `BRAND-AND-TRADEMARK.md` (marks, classes, filing drawings).
- **Patent:** `SOFTWARE-PATENT-FILING-STRATEGY.md` + `PATENT-FEATURE-AND-FUNCTION-DISCLOSURE-BRIEF.md` (invention disclosure and strategy).
- **Payments/merchant:** `PAYMENTS-ARCHITECTURE-AND-MERCHANT-BRIEF.md`.
- **Privacy & terms:** `PRIVACY-POLICY.md`, `TERMS-OF-SERVICE.md`, `LEGAL-PAGES-GUIDE.md`.
- **Deeper compliance:** `COMPLIANCE-AND-ASSUMPTIONS.md`, `COMPLIANCE-AND-CURRENT-STATE.md`, `STRICTEST-STANDARD-COMPLIANCE-POLICY.md`, `GLOBAL-COMPLIANCE-AND-LOCALIZATION.md`.

Prepared for counsel. Not legal advice. This document describes the product as built; the operative legal questions and the exact feature switches are in the documents referenced above.